

Advice for Succeeding in Class

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Read the Syllabus

You are responsible for everything written in the syllabus, from due dates to material covered, and every word in between. Make sure you read and understand it fully *before* the second class.

Attendance

Attending lectures is crucial, for obvious reasons. Aside from emergencies, everyone should attend *every* class.

If you are absent for any reason, you are responsible for *all* the material and announcements covered in the session(s) you missed. Please do not ask me for notes, as I do not have any to share. Make one or more note-taking friends in class so you can share notes, and/or post to our email group asking for a classmate to share their notes.

Also note that being absent from a crit lecture, should the course you're enrolled in offer one, is more egregious than an absence from a regular lecture, since feedback for your project and your feedback for others is very important.

Note: Excessive absences will lead to a failing grade.

Lateness

If you come to class late and miss roll call at the beginning of class, I will not interrupt the lecture to update my roster. It is considered an absence.

Bear in mind that you are responsible for any announcements and/or material you missed before your late arrival to class.

Note: Excessive lateness will be converted to absences, which can lead to failing the course.

Actively Participate in Your Education

A ratio of 3:1 is a common formula used to define student success in a course, with three parts assigned to the student and one part to the professor. Broken down hourly, it means, that, for every hour you spend in class, you *should* spend three hours doing research, reading, doing homework, going over your notes, re-writing your notes, seeking help online, and possibly making appointments to see me in person. This is a general formula—Some students succeed with less time, others with more. A successful use of your time might look like the following:

1. **Take notes.** Unless you have an eidetic memory, take notes. This may seem obvious, but I have encountered myriad situations in which poor-performing students *did not* take notes and could not understand why they were failing class. Consider [The Cornell Note-Taking System](#). Also, consider investing in a smart pen, such as a [LiveScribe pen](#), which will pay itself back in your overall academic success. You might also consider trying to

share notes with others so they can share with you. Multiple perspectives on the same material is always helpful.

2. **Immediately re-write your notes from class.** Re-writing or re-typing your notes immediately after class reinforces the material from the lecture. [The sooner you do this, the more likely it is that you will retain what you learned in class.](#)
3. **Add notes to your notes.** If you use The Cornell Note-Taking system, write comments in the left margin. This allows you to re-word concepts discussed in class, further reinforcing your understanding of the material.
4. **Study and re-write the code written in class and shared on GitHub.** By going over the code in class and re-writing the examples, you will be making the code your own, in turn, gathering a firm understanding of the technological concepts discussed in class.
5. **Search for terms you do not understand.** You are bound to encounter terms and ideas you do not understand. Highlight them in your notes, then search for them on the Internet. Read multiple definitions and take notes.
6. **Ask questions in our email group.** If you would ask a question in class because it pertains to material that relates to all the students, then it is apt to be asked in our email group. Make sure to follow the protocol discussed on the first day of class for asking questions on our email group.
7. **Make an appointment to meet with me.** If, after carrying out steps 1–6, you do not understand something, make an appointment to see me, in person or via video conference. When we meet, have questions prepared.
8. **Ask questions in class.** If you have a question, please, please ask it. You are causing yourself a great disservice by not asking questions in class. The full experience of attending lectures includes the interaction between professors and students.

Submitting Assignments and Projects

Unless otherwise stated in your course's syllabus, *every* assignment and project for this course *must* be submitted via GitHub. **There are *no* exceptions.** Your work is only considered "submitted" when a pull request of your assignment is "approved." We'll discuss in class what this means.

Academic Integrity

The work you submit must be your own. You are welcome to discuss concepts and ideas with your classmates and anyone else, but you are **not** to share code with anyone, and you are **not** to retrieve code from any artificial intelligence tool. See the **Academic Integrity** section of the syllabus for more, including a link to the college's official document on the matter.

Computer Backups

You are responsible for ensuring that your work is backed up continuously. Hard drives and USB flash drives are cheap, and backup methods are simple. There is *no* excuse *not* to backup. As a second backup, use Time Machine for Mac or File History for Windows. As a third-level of redundancy, consider using a cloud storage backup, like [Backblaze](#), [Carbonite](#), or [iDrive](#).